

Class Notes: Phylum Hemichordata

Animal Kingdom • PU-I Biology • Class Notes

Body Plan and Affinities

Earlier placed as a sub-phylum of Chordata; a small group of worm-like marine animals; bilaterally symmetrical, triploblastic, coelomate, organ system level. Body is cylindrical, composed of anterior proboscis, collar and a long trunk.

Reproduction and Examples

Circulatory system open; respiratory organs are gills; excretory organ is the proboscis gland. Sexes separate, fertilisation external, development indirect. Examples: Balanoglossus (tongue worm/acorn worm) and Saccoglossus.